

Unity Launcher

Unity Launcher is an Android app which adds the look of Ubuntu phone OS on your android device. It also adds the swipe-in slider app selector <http://dgit.in/XK0dmn>



Galaxy Note 8.0

Samsung is set to announce its new Galaxy Note 8.0 on March 14 this year. The note 8.0 is supposed to be a competitor to the iPad mini

Work@Tech

Let's get certified

Once you've completed your graduation (or even while you're pursuing it), it's time to get certified. Certifications add weight to your resume and help you demand a higher package. Also, you pick up new skill sets, or at the very minimum, reinforce your existing knowledge. A few much respected institutions that offer special courses specifically for web designers are Maya Academy of Advanced Cinematics; Arena Animation; Doomshell Academy of Advanced Computing, Jaipur; Caba Innovatives, Delhi; Lakhota Computer Centre, Kochi; Gurumantra Institute of Design and Animation, Pune; and Animaster, Bangalore.

Here's a related inspirational story for you. Meet Mayank Yadav, the globe-trotting CEO of Radiate Labs – a creative web and mobile solutions firm based in Gurgaon. Mayank has been developing websites since he was in ninth grade and believes in the concept of self-learning and says that, "learning never ends." If there's a example that mainstream success doesn't always equate with formal education, this is it.

At crossroads – Freelance or Employment?

Eventually, at some point in time, not only a web designer but almost all professionals have to choose which road they want to go down on: a freelancer picking up his own projects or a fully employed professional with a firm. Freelancers typically need to work on a strong portfolio if they expect to find decent work. Since they're not backed by a brand, the onus lies on them to build their own personal brand and market themselves online. A strong social media

Nifty tools and web applications for web designers

Are my site up: This tool helps you to check at one glance if all your servers are up and running <http://aremysitesup.com/>

Firebug: An add-on for Firefox browser which allows you to inspect, edit and monitor CSS, HTML, JavaScript and Net requests in any web page. <http://getfirebug.com/>

FontExplorer X Pro: This works like a suitcase for fonts – a very useful companion www.fontexplorerx.com

ClueApp: The tool helps you answer questions like – which page are the users spending the most time at? <http://www.clueapp.com/>

Kuler: A web hosted application that generates colour themes www.adobe.com

presence is obviously your best bet in this regard. The advantages of working as a freelancer include the freedom to choose your work and set your own timelines; you may find yourself with more spare time which you can use to level-up yourself. Keep some things in mind though: working as a freelancer requires plenty of self-discipline, it's too easy to lay back and watch a movie instead of working, and then there's the lack of stability. One of the cons of being employed is that you have no control over which projects you have to work on – something creative people typically have a problem with. The advantages are quite apparent too: you're assured of a consistent source of income; you're still "in the game,"

so to speak, and can always switch companies and move to greener pastures. In the end, it's solely a question of personal choice: which path suits your idea of work better?

Getting a move on

So where do you look for that perfect job? Some companies that stand out in terms of their body of work, brand image, future prospects offered to employees and overall industry reputation are: Ogilvy & Mather, Ray & Keshavan, Origami Studio, Stark Communications, Webchutney, Solutions Digitas, AgencyDigi and Quasar WPP. There are many others that cater to niche segments. Also, every decent-sized company requires in-house web designers too.

And freelancers? After gaining some experience, establish your online presence – if done right, this should be enough in itself. Or you could begin by picking up a job from one of the many websites that connect freelancers to people offering projects. Head to websites such as Freelancer.com, iFreelance.com and Elance.com.

In terms of compensation, the starting package offered may be humble and anywhere between ₹1,00,000 to ₹1,20,000, but with years of experience under your belt and a strong portfolio even fetching ₹10,00,000-12,00,000 or more is not implausible. As for the future, Web 2.0 has come and gone, HTML 5 is here and today there is talk of responsive web design – essentially websites that adapt to the kind of device they are being viewed on. "Everything is getting an 'e' in it (as with e-Commerce, e-meetings etc.) So my suggestion is just give it your best shot", says Mayank. On that rather motivational note, happy designing! 



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